

Table 6.1.14 : Distribution of Population by Religion and District, 2012

District	Religion						
	Total	Buddhist	Hindu	Islam	Roman Catholic	Other Christian	Other
Sri Lanka	20,359,439	14,272,056	2,561,299	1,967,523	1,261,194	290,967	6,400
Colombo	2,324,349	1,632,225	186,454	274,087	162,314	66,994	2,275
Gampaha	2,304,833	1,642,767	52,973	112,746	449,398	46,080	869
Kalutara	1,221,948	1,018,909	39,541	114,556	39,774	8,956	212
Kandy	1,375,382	1,009,220	133,744	197,076	22,379	12,798	165
Matale	484,531	385,151	43,432	45,682	7,899	2,342	25
Nuwara Eliya	711,644	278,254	363,163	21,116	33,476	15,508	127
Galle	1,063,334	998,647	15,584	39,267	4,415	5,315	106
Matara	814,048	766,323	16,421	25,614	2,432	3,208	50
Hambantota	599,903	580,344	1,222	15,204	1,139	1,692	302
Jaffna	583,882	2,168	483,255	2,363	75,474	20,511	111
Mannar	99,570	1,809	24,027	16,512	52,415	4,790	17
Vavuniya	172,115	16,853	119,401	11,972	15,305	8,498	86
Mullaitivu	92,238	8,185	69,377	1,880	9,063	3,664	69
Kilinochchi	113,510	1,275	92,986	700	12,063	6,436	50
Batticaloa	526,567	6,281	338,882	134,065	24,454	22,833	52
Ampara	649,402	251,427	102,829	281,987	7,588	5,541	30
Trincomalee	379,541	99,344	98,442	159,418	14,493	7,774	70
Kurunegala	1,618,465	1,431,632	14,721	118,305	43,711	9,926	170
Puttalam	762,396	329,705	28,811	150,404	240,221	12,093	1,162
Anuradhapura	860,575	775,366	3,231	71,493	6,747	3,660	78
Polonnaruwa	406,088	364,229	6,886	30,465	3,192	1,276	40
Badulla	815,405	591,799	157,608	47,192	12,020	6,615	171
Moneragala	451,058	426,762	11,997	9,809	1,601	859	30
Ratnapura	1,088,007	943,464	101,962	24,446	10,844	7,212	79
Kegalle	840,648	709,917	54,350	61,164	8,777	6,386	54

According to the Census 2012 data, the total population of the country was 20,359,439. Significant variations in the geographical distribution of the major religious groups can be analyzed as follows, based on Table 6.1.14. The total Buddhist population is 14,272,056 and the highest concentration is reported in Gampaha (1,642,767), Colombo (1,632,225), and Kurunegala (1,431,632) districts. The Hindu population totals 2,561,299 and is primarily distributed across the Jaffna (483,255), Nuwara Eliya (363,163), and Batticaloa (338,882) districts. The total number of Islamic adherents is 1,967,523, with the highest numbers reported in the Ampara (281,987), Colombo (274,087), and Kandy (197,076) districts. The Roman Catholic population is largely concentrated in the Gampaha (449,398), Puttalam (240,221), and Colombo (162,314) districts. Similarly, the highest populations belonging to other Christian denominations are reported from the Colombo and Gampaha districts.